Cut along the dashed lines. Print double-sided and flip on the long edge.

MYTH

Dengue and mosquitoes

Tawa-tawa cures dengue.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

Dengue and mosquitoes

Papaya leaf juice is the real cure for dengue.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

Dengue and mosquitoes

Dengue mosquitoes only bite at night.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

Dengue and mosquitoes

Dengue mosquitoes breed only in dirty water.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

Dengue and mosquitoes

Fogging is all we need to stop dengue.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

Medicines

Antibiotics cure colds and flu.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

Medicines

Stop antibiotics once you feel better and save the rest.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

Medicines

A herbal tea can replace your maintenance meds.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

✓ FACT

Papaya leaf is not a proven dengue cure. Care means fluids and close watch by health workers.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Stories of a neighbour who drank it and recovered spread fast. Most people with dengue do recover, so the juice gets the credit.

✓ FACT

No herb is proven to cure dengue. If you have a high fever, see a health worker early.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Tawa-tawa is a remedy passed down with love, and many families tried it while someone got better. When a child is sick, we want to do something.

✓ FACT

They breed in clean standing water. Cover, clean and empty containers every week.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Dirty canals look like the obvious problem. A clean flower pot or a drum of rain water does not look dangerous at all.

✓ FACT

Aedes mosquitoes, which spread dengue, bite mostly in the daytime.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

We sleep under a mosquito net at night and hear mosquitoes buzz in the dark, so night feels like the danger time.

✓ FACT

Colds and flu come from viruses. Antibiotics only work on bacteria. Ask a health worker first.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Someone once felt better after antibiotics, so it seemed to work. Colds often get better on their own around that time anyway.

✓ FACT

Fogging helps only in hotspot areas. Emptying standing water every week matters most.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Fogging is loud and visible, so it feels like strong action. Cleaning containers is quiet work that nobody sees.

✓ FACT

Do not stop or change maintenance medicines without talking to your doctor.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Taking pills every day is tiring and costly. A natural tea that promises freedom from pills sounds like a gift.

✓ FACT

Use antibiotics exactly as a health worker says. Misuse helps germs become resistant.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Feeling better feels like being done, and saving medicine for next time seems thrifty and smart.

Cut along the dashed lines. Print double-sided and flip on the long edge.

MYTH

Medicines

If it is natural, it is always safe.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

Medicines

A food supplement can cure your illness.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

Medicines

An FDA number means it cures whatever the ad says.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

Vaccines

Vaccines are never checked after they come out.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

Vaccines

A fever after a vaccine means it is dangerous.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

Vaccines

Good vaccines are only for people who can pay.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

Vaccines

Sharing every vaccine warning keeps my family safe.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

BP, sugar and cancer

You will feel it if your blood pressure is high.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

Cut along the dashed lines. Print double-sided and flip on the long edge.

✓ FACT

Supplements are not medicine. In the Philippines their labels must say "No approved therapeutic claims".

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Supplement ads look like medicine ads, with doctors, charts and happy families. It is hard to tell them apart.

✓ FACT

Natural does not mean safe. Some herbs can harm you or clash with medicines.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Plants from the garden feel gentle and familiar, and our elders used them. Factory pills feel strong and strange.

✓ FACT

Vaccines are tested in large studies and monitored after approval. Side effects are reported and reviewed.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

We rarely see the safety work, so it is easy to think nobody is watching. Worry about our children is natural.

✓ FACT

Registration is not proof of every claim. Health claims on supplements are a red flag.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

An official-looking number feels like a stamp of approval for the whole ad, not just the product.

✓ FACT

Routine childhood vaccines are available free at health centers.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Many things that matter cost money, so free can feel like second-best. Not everyone hears about free programs.

✓ FACT

Most side effects are mild and short, like a sore arm or mild fever. Serious ones are rare.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Seeing your child feverish is scary, and scary stories get shared more than calm ones.

✓ FACT

High blood pressure often has no symptoms. Regular checks at the health center help.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Some people do get headaches, so it makes sense to wait for a sign. Feeling fine feels like being fine.

✓ FACT

Fear spreads faster than facts. Checking with a health worker first is a caring habit.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Forwarding a warning feels like protecting the people we love. Nobody wants to be the one who stayed quiet.

Cut along the dashed lines. Print double-sided and flip on the long edge.

MYTH

BP, sugar and cancer

Ampalaya tea cures diabetes.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

BP, sugar and cancer

A secret herbal mix cures cancer, but doctors hide it.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

BP, sugar and cancer

Once my BP is normal, I can stop my maintenance meds.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

Everyday health

Washing hands after hard work causes pasma, a hand ailment.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

Everyday health

A cough that lasts for weeks is just a normal cough.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

Everyday health

A home remedy is enough for a small dog bite.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

Everyday health

Flood water is harmless if you feel fine after.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

Everyday health

Drink less during diarrhea so it stops sooner.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

✓ FACT

There is no proven herbal cure for cancer. Early check-ups and screening help.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Cancer is frightening and treatment is hard. A gentle secret cure gives hope when we need it most.

✓ FACT

Ampalaya is a healthy vegetable, but there is no proven herbal cure for diabetes.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Ampalaya is bitter and good for us, and many grandparents swear by it. It feels like strong medicine.

✓ FACT

Washing with soap and water helps prevent infections. If hand pain or shaking continues, see a health worker.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Pasma is a folk belief our elders passed down to protect us. Tired, aching hands after work are real, and the warning comes from care.

✓ FACT

A normal reading often means the medicine is working. Ask your doctor before any change.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

A good reading feels like being cured. It is natural to hope the pills are no longer needed.

✓ FACT

Wash the wound with soap and running water, then go to an animal bite center right away.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Small bites look harmless, and traditional healers are close and trusted. The pet may be family too.

✓ FACT

A cough of 2 weeks or more should be checked for TB. TB is curable, with free treatment.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Coughs are common, and nobody wants to bother the health center for "just a cough".

✓ FACT

ORS helps prevent dehydration from diarrhea. See a health worker for danger signs.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Less going in seems like less coming out. It is a logical guess when you are tired and worried.

✓ FACT

Wading in flood water raises leptospirosis risk. See a health worker after exposure.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

During floods we wade because we must. Feeling fine the next day makes it seem like nothing happened.

Cut along the dashed lines. Print double-sided and flip on the long edge.

MYTH

Everyday health

If water looks clear, it is safe to drink.

WHO CAN HELP

Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

Everyday health

Vaping is harmless because it is just water vapour.

WHO CAN HELP

Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

Everyday health

Teens are young and strong, so they need less sleep.

WHO CAN HELP

Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

AI and online

If a message was forwarded many times, it must be true.

WHO CAN HELP

Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

AI and online

A chatbot always tells the truth.

WHO CAN HELP

Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

AI and online

A health chatbot can diagnose me like a doctor.

WHO CAN HELP

Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

AI and online

If a doctor is in the video ad, the product works.

WHO CAN HELP

Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

AI and online

You can always spot a fake video by its glitches.

WHO CAN HELP

Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

✓ FACT

Smoking and vaping both harm the lungs and heart.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Vapes smell sweet and look like a clean mist, and they are often sold as the safer choice.

✓ FACT

Clear water can still carry germs. Bringing it to a rolling boil makes it safer.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

We judge with our eyes, and clean-looking water from a familiar source feels safe.

✓ FACT

Many shares do not make a claim true. Check the source before you forward.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

When many people we trust share something, it feels checked already. Sharing is how we care for each other.

✓ FACT

Teens need more sleep than adults. Sleep supports mood, memory and the immune system.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Teens seem full of energy late at night, and adults remember pulling all-nighters too.

✓ FACT

Chatbots cannot examine you and are not doctors. They can help you prepare questions.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Clinics can be far and busy, and the chatbot is always awake. It feels like a doctor in your pocket.

✓ FACT

Chatbots can sound sure and still be wrong. Check health answers with a health worker.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Chatbots answer fast, in neat sentences, with a confident tone. That sounds like an expert.

✓ FACT

AI fakes can look and sound real. Checking the source works better than hunting glitches.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Early fakes had odd blinking and blurry mouths, and tips for spotting them went viral.

✓ FACT

Doctor videos can be faked with AI. A real doctor selling a miracle product is a red flag.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

We were taught to respect doctors. A familiar white coat and a calm voice feel trustworthy.

Cut along the dashed lines. Print double-sided and flip on the long edge.

MYTH

AI and online

If "they" deleted the post, it must be true.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

AI and online

An "AI-powered" health product must be smarter and safer.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

AI and online

My phone shows tea ads because it secretly listens to me.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

Dengue and mosquitoes

I already had dengue, so I cannot get it again.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

Dengue and mosquitoes

Once the fever breaks, dengue is over.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

Dengue and mosquitoes

Any pain reliever at home is fine for a dengue fever.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

Dengue and mosquitoes

Dengue is only a problem during the rainy season.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

Medicines

Leftover antibiotics can be shared with a sick family member.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

✓ FACT

"AI-powered" is often just a sales label. Ask what it does and whether it is proven.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

AI is in the news every day, so the word sounds modern and impressive.

✓ FACT

Posts are removed for many reasons, including false health claims. Removal is not proof.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Being told something is hidden makes it feel precious. Nobody likes the feeling of being kept in the dark.

✓ FACT

There are four types of dengue virus. A second infection can be more severe, so stay careful.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

After a hard bout of dengue, it feels fair to think the body is now protected. Some illnesses, like chickenpox, usually come only once.

✓ FACT

Apps learn patterns from what you tap, watch and search, then guess what to show you.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

The ads can feel spookily on point, right after we talked about something. Of course it feels like listening.

✓ FACT

Some common pain relievers can raise bleeding risk in dengue. Ask a health worker before taking any.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Pain relievers are in almost every home, and we reach for them at every fever. It feels like the fastest way to help.

✓ FACT

Severe dengue signs often appear after the fever goes away. Keep watching for warning signs.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

A falling fever is usually the best news a family can get. After days of worry, everyone is ready to rest.

✓ FACT

Antibiotics are chosen for one person and one infection. Sharing them can harm and fuel resistance.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Sharing medicine feels like caring, and it saves money. If it helped one person, it seems sure to help another.

✓ FACT

Dengue can spread all year. Cases peak in the rainy months, so empty water containers every week.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Dengue news comes mostly with the rains, so the dry months feel safe. Good habits are easy to drop when the danger seems gone.

Cut along the dashed lines. Print double-sided and flip on the long edge.

MYTH

Medicines

Generic medicines are weaker than branded ones.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

Medicines

Medicine from any online seller is the same as from a pharmacy.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

Medicines

The more vitamins you take, the healthier you get.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

Vaccines

Vaccines cause autism.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

Vaccines

Catching measles naturally is better than getting the vaccine.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

Vaccines

Too many vaccines at once will overload a baby.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

Vaccines

Vaccines are only for babies and children.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

BP, sugar and cancer

Cervical cancer cannot be prevented.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

✓ FACT

Fake and substandard medicines are often sold online. Buy from licensed pharmacies.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Online shops are cheap and close at hand, and the boxes look just like the real ones. For many families, the pharmacy is far.

✓ FACT

Registered generics have the same active ingredient as the brand and must meet quality standards.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

We often think a higher price means better quality. A familiar name on the box feels more trustworthy than a plain label.

✓ FACT

Many large studies, reviewed again by WHO safety experts in 2025, show vaccines do not cause autism.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Signs of autism often show up around the age children get vaccines, so the timing feels connected. Parents want answers, and that worry comes from love.

✓ FACT

Too much of some vitamins and minerals can harm you. Supplements do not replace a varied diet.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Vitamins sound like pure goodness, and ads promise energy and strong immunity. More of a good thing feels even better.

✓ FACT

Babies meet many germs every day. Vaccines given together are tested and do not overload the immune system.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Watching a small baby get several shots in one visit is hard for any parent. Wanting to protect them is natural.

✓ FACT

Measles can cause pneumonia, blindness, brain swelling and death. The vaccine protects without those risks.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

"Natural" sounds gentle and strong, and many older relatives had measles as kids and got through it. Those memories feel like proof.

✓ FACT

Most cervical cancer can be prevented with HPV vaccination and regular screening.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Cancer can feel like bad luck that nobody controls. Fear makes many of us avoid check-ups, even the ones that could help.

✓ FACT

Some vaccines, like flu and pneumonia vaccines, are also advised for seniors and some adults.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Most vaccine talk is about babies, and many adults have not had a shot since school. It is easy to think we are done.

Cut along the dashed lines. Print double-sided and flip on the long edge.

✕ MYTH

BP, sugar and cancer

A biopsy or an operation makes cancer spread.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

✕ MYTH

BP, sugar and cancer

Only people who eat a lot of sweets get diabetes.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

✕ MYTH

BP, sugar and cancer

Maintenance medicines will ruin your kidneys.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

✕ MYTH

BP, sugar and cancer

Pricking the fingertips can save someone having a stroke.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

✕ MYTH

Everyday health

Depression is just a weak mind. Be strong and it will pass.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

✕ MYTH

Everyday health

Children only need deworming if you can see worms.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

✕ MYTH

Everyday health

Formula milk makes babies smarter than breast milk.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

✕ MYTH

Everyday health

Only the elderly can get heat stroke.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

Cut along the dashed lines. Print double-sided and flip on the long edge.

✓ FACT

Type 2 diabetes is linked to weight, little exercise and family history, not just sweets.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Diabetes is often just called "sugar", so it makes sense to blame sweets. People who skip dessert may feel safe.

✓ FACT

The chance that surgery spreads cancer is extremely low. Delaying care gives cancer time to grow.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Someone we knew may have gotten worse after an operation, and the story stuck. The cancer was often already advanced, but the operation got the blame.

✓ FACT

A stroke is an emergency. Get the person to a hospital right away; pricking fingers only wastes time.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

In a scary moment, a simple trick feels like something we can do with our own hands. The tip is often shared as a life-saver.

✓ FACT

Uncontrolled high blood pressure and sugar harm the kidneys. Ask your doctor before changing any medicine.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Taking pills every day for years is worrying, and many families know someone on dialysis. Fearing the medicine is understandable.

✓ FACT

Worm infections often show no signs. Free deworming at school and health centers protects children.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

If a child looks healthy and eats well, there seems to be nothing to treat. Worms are not something families like to talk about.

✓ FACT

Depression is a common health condition, not weakness. It can be treated, and help is available.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Many of us were raised to endure hardship quietly. Saying "be strong" is how families try to lift each other up.

✓ FACT

Anyone can get heat stroke, including young workers and athletes. It is a medical emergency.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Heat warnings usually mention lolos and lolas. Young people feel strong and used to the sun.

✓ FACT

Breast milk is the best first food and protects babies from infections. Health workers can help.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Formula ads show bright, strong babies, and many moms worry their milk is not enough. Wanting the best for a baby is love.

Cut along the dashed lines. Print double-sided and flip on the long edge.

MYTH

Everyday health

TB runs in the family, so it is passed down by blood.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

AI and online

A call in my child's voice asking for hospital money is real.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

AI and online

Hundreds of happy comments prove a product works.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

AI and online

A product that cures many diseases at once is a breakthrough.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

AI and online

What I tell a health chatbot stays private, like a clinic visit.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

Coughs, flu and outbreaks

If many people post about fever online, it is an official outbreak.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

Coughs, flu and outbreaks

An outbreak warning in the group chat is always true.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

Coughs, flu and outbreaks

The flu is just a bad cold.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

✓ FACT

Voices can be cloned with AI. Hang up and call the person back on a number you know.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Hearing a loved one in trouble makes the heart race. Scammers count on that love and rush you before you can think.

✓ FACT

TB spreads through the air when a sick person coughs. It is preventable and curable, with free treatment.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

TB often shows up in several people in one home, so it looks inherited. Living close together is the real reason.

✓ FACT

Claiming to cure many unrelated diseases is a classic warning sign, not a breakthrough.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Living with several illnesses is tiring and costly. One product for everything sounds like the answer to a prayer.

✓ FACT

Comments and reviews can be fake or paid. Many stories together are still not evidence.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

When many people seem happy, it feels safe to join them. Stories from people like us feel more real than studies.

✓ FACT

Online posts are early clues. Health workers check them first, and health authorities announce real outbreaks.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

When the feed fills with sick neighbours, it feels like proof. Worry for our families makes every post seem urgent.

✓ FACT

Chats may be stored or used to improve the AI. Keep your full name, ID numbers and diagnoses out.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Chatbots feel personal and patient, so it is easy to open up. Unlike a clinic, the privacy rules for chats are often unclear.

✓ FACT

Flu often starts suddenly with fever and body aches. It can be serious for seniors, young children and pregnant women.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Both start with a cough and a runny nose, and most people get better at home. So it is easy to treat them the same.

✓ FACT

Rumours often spread faster than checks. Real outbreak news comes from DOH and local health offices.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Family chats are where we look out for each other. A warning from someone we love feels too important to doubt.

Cut along the dashed lines. Print double-sided and flip on the long edge.

MYTH

Coughs, flu and outbreaks

The flu vaccine gives you the flu.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

Coughs, flu and outbreaks

A small cough is no reason to cover my mouth or wear a mask.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

Coughs, flu and outbreaks

Pneumonia is just a bad cold that goes away on its own.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

Coughs, flu and outbreaks

A quick rinse with water is enough to clean my hands.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

HIV

You can get HIV from sharing food, hugging or mosquito bites.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

HIV

HIV is a death sentence.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

HIV

People living with HIV will always pass it to their partners.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

HIV

An HIV test costs a lot, and everyone will find out the result.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

✓ FACT

Even a mild cough can spread germs. Cover it with a tissue or your elbow, and wear a mask around others.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

When we feel only a little sick, we do not want to make a fuss. Masks can also feel awkward in a crowd.

✓ FACT

Flu shots cannot cause flu. A sore arm or mild fever may happen and passes quickly.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Some people catch a cold soon after a shot, so the shot gets the blame. Protection also takes about two weeks to build.

✓ FACT

Washing with soap and water for at least 20 seconds removes far more germs and helps stop infections spreading.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Hands that look clean feel clean, and soap is not always nearby. A quick rinse feels like enough on a busy day.

✓ FACT

Pneumonia is a lung infection that can be serious. Fast or hard breathing needs a health worker right away.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Pneumonia often starts like a cough or cold, so it is easy to wait it out. Many families hope rest at home is enough.

✓ FACT

With treatment, people living with HIV can live long, healthy lives. Treatment is free at DOH treatment hubs.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Many of us remember stories from years ago, before good treatment was easy to get. Those sad memories stay strong.

✓ FACT

HIV does not spread through hugs, kisses, shared food or utensils, toilets or mosquito bites.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

HIV was once surrounded by fear and little information, and some of those old warnings are still repeated. Wanting to stay safe is natural.

✓ FACT

HIV testing is free at government treatment hubs and many clinics, and the law keeps results confidential.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Worry about money and about what others will say is real. Fear of gossip keeps many people from getting tested.

✓ FACT

People with HIV who take treatment and keep an undetectable viral load do not pass HIV on through sex.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

This good news is newer than the old fears, and few people talk about it. Most of us learned about HIV when it was scarier.

✕ MYTH

HIV

Only some kinds of people get HIV.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

✕ MYTH

HIV

There is no medicine that can help prevent HIV.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

✕ MYTH

HIV

You can tell if someone has HIV just by looking at them.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

✕ MYTH

HIV

A map of online HIV talk shows where HIV cases are.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

✕ MYTH

AI in health care

AI in a hospital makes decisions on its own.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

✕ MYTH

AI in health care

AI cannot be biased because it is a machine.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

✕ MYTH

AI in health care

An AI health app with five-star ratings must be accurate.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

✕ MYTH

AI in health care

You cannot ask how an AI reached its result.

WHO CAN HELP
Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

✓ FACT

PrEP is a medicine that greatly lowers the chance of getting HIV. A health worker can tell if it suits you.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Most of us only heard about condoms and testing, so a prevention medicine sounds too good to be true. New health news travels slowly.

✓ FACT

HIV can affect anyone. Testing and prevention are for everyone, without judgment.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

News stories often focus on a few groups, so HIV can feel like a problem for other people. That makes it easy to skip testing.

✓ FACT

It shows where people post about HIV, not where cases are. Official case counts come from DOH.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Colourful maps look scientific and exact. It is easy to forget they only count posts, and some places post more than others.

✓ FACT

Many people with HIV look and feel well for years. Only a test can tell anyone's HIV status.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Old pictures in the news showed very sick people, so that image stuck. It is natural to trust what we see.

✓ FACT

AI learns from data made by people. If the data leaves groups out, the AI can be unfair to them.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Machines feel neutral because they have no feelings. Numbers and computers can seem fairer than people.

✓ FACT

Health workers stay responsible. AI gives suggestions that trained people check before they decide.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Movies and news make AI sound like a robot doctor. When a machine seems smart, it is easy to picture it in charge.

✓ FACT

You can ask. Health workers should explain in plain words what the AI looked at and how they used it.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

AI can seem like a black box that even experts do not understand. It may feel rude to question a doctor or a machine.

✓ FACT

Ratings show if people like an app, not if its health advice is right. Ask if it was tested.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Stars and happy reviews are quick to read and feel like advice from friends. Checking studies takes time we do not have.

Cut along the dashed lines. Print double-sided and flip on the long edge.

MYTH

AI in health care

With a health chatbot, I can skip my regular check-ups.

WHO CAN HELP

Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

AI in health care

Health data I give an app is never shared with anyone.

WHO CAN HELP

Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

AI in health care

An AI that is right most of the time will be right for me.

WHO CAN HELP

Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

AI in health care

Trusting AI means trusting it fully.

WHO CAN HELP

Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

Dengue and mosquitoes

Aedes mosquitoes spread only dengue.

WHO CAN HELP

Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

Dengue and mosquitoes

A bottle cap of water is too small to breed mosquitoes.

WHO CAN HELP

Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

Dengue and mosquitoes

Reporting a breeding site to the barangay does not help.

WHO CAN HELP

Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

MYTH

Dengue and mosquitoes

Stopping mosquito diseases is only a job for health workers.

WHO CAN HELP

Not sure about a health claim? Ask your barangay health worker or your health center.

✓ FACT

Some apps share data with other companies. The privacy notice must tell you, and the law gives you rights.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Apps look friendly and official, and privacy notices are long. Most of us tap "agree" to get on with our day.

✓ FACT

A chatbot cannot examine you or run tests. Keep your check-ups and use chatbots only for general information.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Chatbots are free, fast and awake at midnight, while clinics mean travel, lines and costs. Saving time and money matters.

✓ FACT

Good trust fits the task: rely on AI where it is proven, and double-check it when the stakes are high.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

It feels simpler to trust a tool all the way or not at all. Partial trust sounds confusing, but it is what careful people do.

✓ FACT

An AI can do well on average but miss people unlike those in its training data. Ask how it was tested.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

A score like "90% accurate" sounds like a promise to each of us. Averages are easy to read as personal guarantees.

✓ FACT

Aedes mosquitoes can breed in very little clean water, like caps, plant trays and old tires.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

A tiny bit of water does not look like a danger. We picture mosquitoes coming from big canals and ponds.

✓ FACT

The same Aedes mosquitoes can also spread chikungunya and Zika. Stopping them protects against all three.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Dengue is the mosquito disease we hear about most. Names like chikungunya and Zika can sound far away.

✓ FACT

It takes everyone. People, animals and our surroundings share health, so clean yards and drains protect all.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

Health feels like something for clinics and doctors. Cleaning drains and yards does not feel like health work.

✓ FACT

Community reports help barangays and LGUs find and clean up breeding sites before cases rise.

WHY PEOPLE BELIEVE IT

It can feel like reports go nowhere, or that one person cannot make a difference. Many of us also do not want to bother anyone.